

```

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-->

```

NSObjectProtocol

The group of methods that are fundamental to all Objective-C objects.

...

protocol NSObjectProtocol

Overview> Note:

> This protocol is imported into Swift with the name `NSObjectProtocol`.

An object that conforms to this protocol can be considered a first-class object.
Such an object can be asked about its:

- Class, and the place of its class in the inheritance hierarchy.
- Conformance to protocols.
- Ability to respond to a particular message.

The Cocoa root class [`NSObject`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-swift.class) adopts this protocol, so all objects inheriting from [`NSObject`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-swift.class) have the features described by this protocol.

Topics

Identifying Classes

[`- class`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/class)

Returns the class object for the receiver's class.

[`superclass`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/superclass)

Returns the class object for the receiver's superclass.

Identifying and Comparing Objects

`[`- isEqual:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/isEqual(_:))`

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver and a given object are equal.

`[`hash`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/hash)`

Returns an integer that can be used as a table address in a hash table structure.

`[`- self`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/self())`

Returns the receiver.

Testing Object Inheritance, Behavior, and Conformance

`[`- isKindOfClass:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/isKind(of:))`

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver is an instance of given class or an instance of any class that inherits from that class.

`[`- isKindOfClass:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/isMember(of:))`

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver is an instance of a given class.

`[`- respondsToSelector:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/responds(to:))`

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver implements or inherits a method that can respond to a specified message.

`[`- conformsToProtocol:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/conforms(to:))`

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver conforms to a given protocol.

Describing Objects

`[`description`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/description)`

A textual representation of the receiver.

`[`debugDescription`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/debugDescription)`

A textual representation of the receiver to use with a debugger.

Sending Messages

`[`- performSelector:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/perform(_:))`

Sends a specified message to the receiver and returns the result of the message.

`[`- performSelector:withObject:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/perform(_:with:))`

Sends a message to the receiver with an object as the argument.

[`- performSelector:withObject:withObject:`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/perform(_:with:with:))

Sends a message to the receiver with two objects as arguments.

Identifying Proxies

[`- isProxy`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObjectProtocol/isProxy())

Returns a Boolean value that indicates whether the receiver does not descend from [NSObject`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-swift.class).

Obsolete Methods

[`- retain`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/retain)

Increments the receiver's reference count.

[`- release`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/release)

Decrements the receiver's reference count.

[`- autorelease`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/autorelease)

Decrements the receiver's retain count at the end of the current autorelease pool block.

[`- retainCount`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/retainCount)

Do not use this method.

[`- zone`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-c.protocol/zone)

Zones are deprecated and ignored by most classes that have it as a parameter.

Relationships

Conforming Types

[NSObject-swift.class`](/documentation/ObjectiveC/NSObject-swift.class)

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